

double massages. Say no to chocolate spa treatments and romantic boat cruises. Stay away from any packages using the term “honeymoon.” And don’t plan to leave right after the ceremony. Be flexible with your times and suss out the deals. Instead of a honeymoon, cash in a few vacation days and lounge around the house. Call *that* your honeymoon. Ask friends with a lake house to let you have it for a few days. Then use the honeymoon money to put a down payment on your first home.

Savings: \$1,000–\$10,000-plus.

4. **No flowers.** Flower arrangements at weddings are a tragic waste of money. People spend a fortune picking them out, arranging them perfectly, sticking them in bowls, wrapping ribbons around the vases, transporting them to the hall, then *throwing them in the garbage a few hours later*. Try this handy decorating tip from Mr. Wonderful. Take \$5,000 worth of \$20 bills, which is an amount lots of people budget for flowers. Fold them into pretty origami roses. Put them on sticks. Arrange them in vases. At the end of the night, instruct each wedding table to light the money on fire. This would be cheaper than flowers and would save on composting.

Savings: \$1,000–\$5,000-plus.

5. **Get married on a Monday.** Okay. Maybe not a Monday, but definitely don’t get married on a Saturday, because everything’s at a premium on a Saturday. You’ll pay extra for parking for the limo, for the hall, and for that last-minute seamstress session. Get married on a Thursday or Friday night. Get married in the winter. Be a little different. A weekday wedding will also force your binge-drinking cousin (who shouldn’t be invited anyway—see below) to go easy on the bottle. Take the next day off work, though. Live a little.

Savings: \$2,000–\$5,000.

6. **Keep the guest list minimal.** Weddings are priced by the head, so you have to be like the doorman at the hottest club in town.